

HOW TO MAKE FANTASTIC FOSSILS

The main ingredient for fossil-making is plaster of Paris. This is a powder that becomes a thick liquid when mixed with water, and then sets hard. For safety, find an adult to help you when handling this material. Picking an object that will make a good fossil is the fun part: this can be a shell, or anything with an interesting shape and texture.

WHAT YOU NEED



Plastic bowl



Shell



Paint



Plaster of Paris



Modeling clay



Measuring cup filled with water



Spoon



Paintbrush



Time

10 minutes plus
12 hours drying time



Difficulty

Easy

Warning

Seek an adult's help when
using plaster of Paris



1 Mix up the plaster of Paris using a little less water than most packages tell you to. One cup of plaster to one cup of water should give you the nice thick liquid you need to work with.



2 Next, line the bottom of the plastic bowl with the modeling clay. You'll need a layer about $\frac{3}{4}$ in (2cm) deep. Press the clay down with your fingers to make it as flat as you can.

